

# **Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer**

## **Problem Statement:**

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

## **User Story:**

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

## **Project Objective:**

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

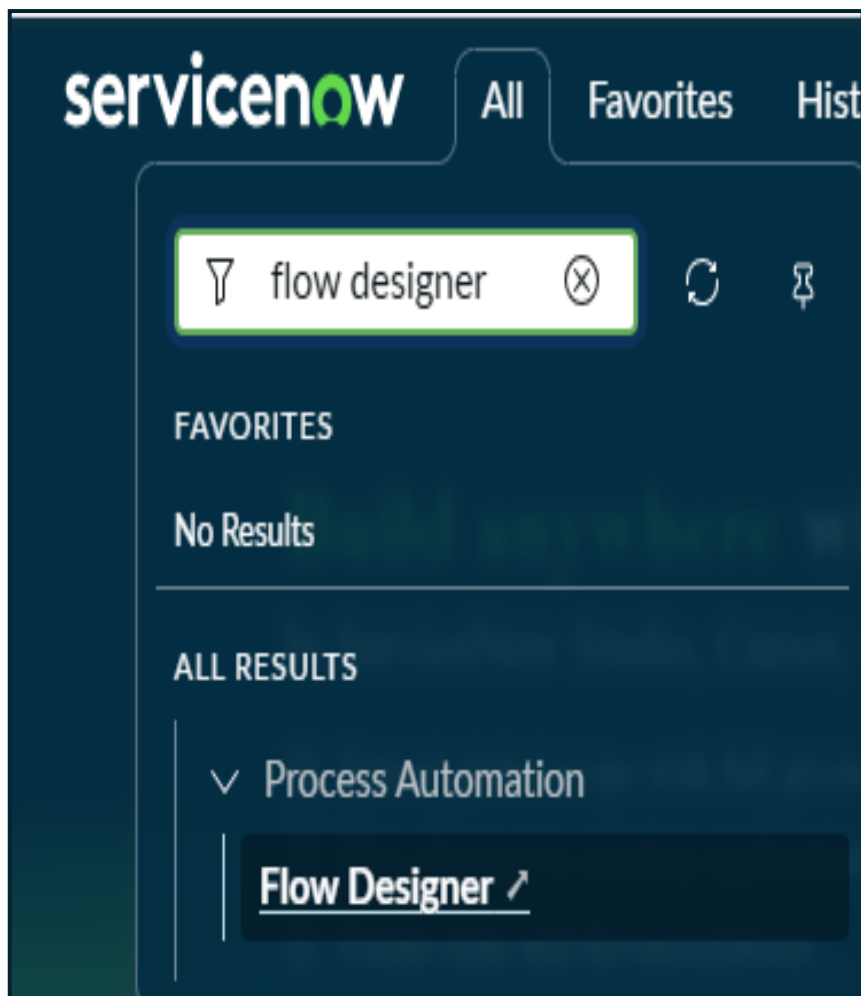
1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

## TASK INITIATION

### Milestone 1 : Flow

**Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.**

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.



Homepage Operations Integrations

Playbooks **Flows** Subflows Triggers Actions Decision tables

New ▾

Pick up where you left off

- Standard laptop task  
Last updated: 13 h. ago by Syste...
- Deployment Migration t...  
Last updated: a year ago by Syste...
- Multi-factor Authentica...  
Last updated: a year ago by Syste...

Latest updates

- System Administrator modified Standard laptop task  
13 h. ago

Flows 94  
Last refreshed just now.

| Name ▲                                       | Application        | Status    | Active | Update             |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------|-----------|--------|--------------------|
| Application Intake Request Flow (Deprecated) | Application Intake | Published | false  | 2026-09-13 03:16:5 |
| Application Intake Request V2                | Application Intake | Published | true   | 2026-09-13 03:16:5 |
| Benchmark Recommendation Evaluator           | Benchmarks Spoke   | Published | true   | 2026-06-13 03:16:5 |
| Business process approval flow               | Global             | Published | true   | 2020-09-27 22:06:1 |
| Change - Cloud Infrastructure - Authorize    | Global             | Published | true   | 2020-11-11 07:08:0 |

Playbook  
Flow  
Subflow  
Trigger  
Action  
Decision table  
Help me decide

Workflow Studio

New Flow  
Flow • None

### Let's get the details for your flow

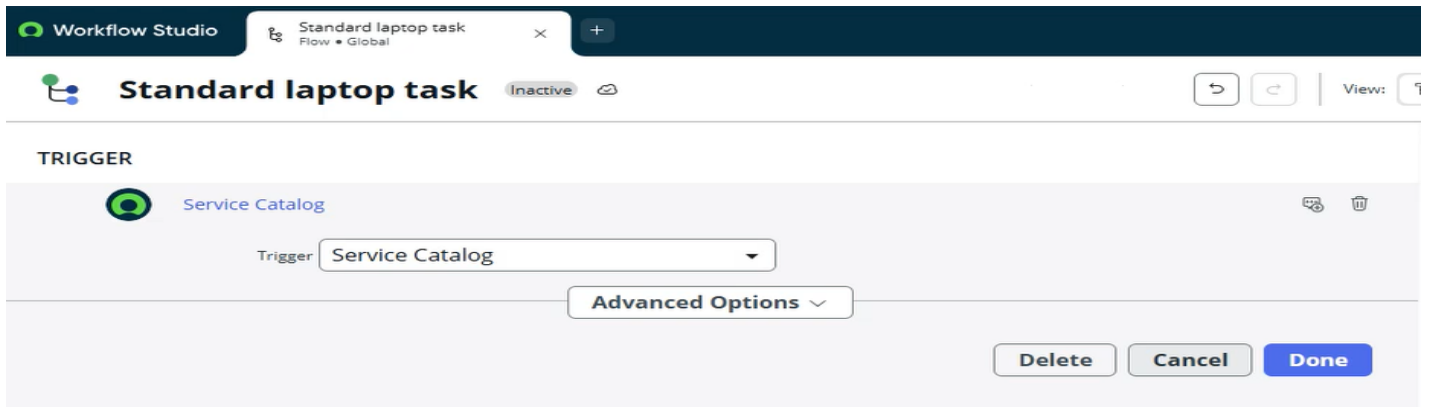
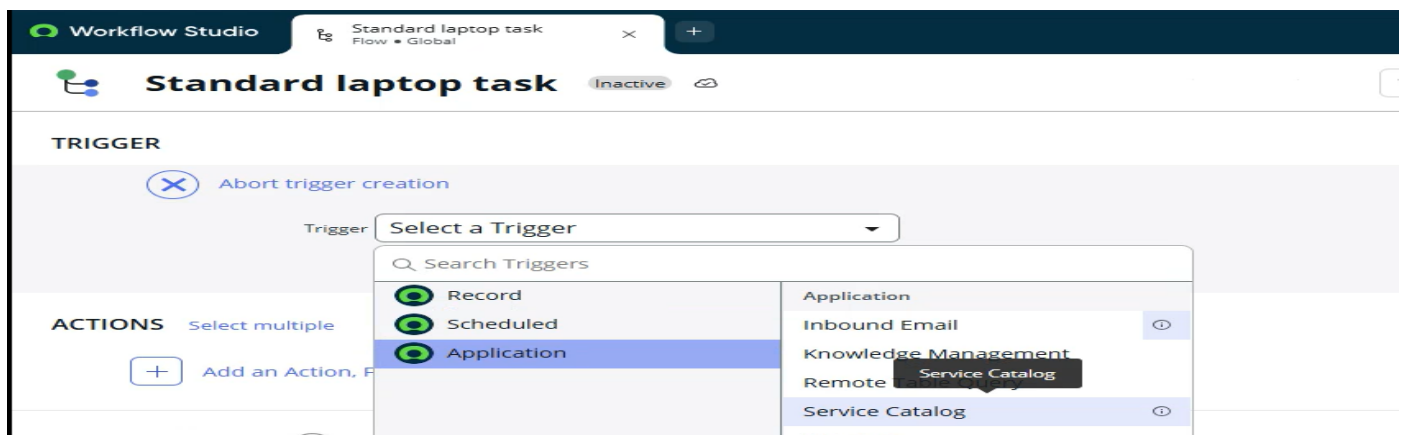
Flow name \* ⓘ  
Standard laptop task

Application \* ⓘ  
Global  
Describe your flow for documentation.

Description ⓘ  
Describe your flow.

> Show additional properties

- Click on Add a trigger
- Select the trigger in that Search for “Service Catalog” and select that.
- After that click on Done.



12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
22. Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
23. Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
25. Click on save the Flow.
26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.

## TRIGGER



Service Catalog

## ACTIONS Select multiple



Action

Flow Logic

Subflow

create catalog

### INSTALLED SPOKES

ServiceNow Core

ITSM

### NOT INSTALLED SPOKES

IntegrationHub

Service Catalog

Create Catalog Task

## ERROR HANDLING

If an error occurs



## Standard laptop task

Inactive



View:



Test



Activate



1

Create Catalog Task



### Action Properties

Action Create Catalog Task

### Action Inputs

Table Name Catalog Task [sc\_task]

\* Requested Item [Requested Item] Drag and drop Requested Item pill

Short Description

### Data Collapse All

#### Flow Variables

#### Requested Item Record

#### Requested Item Record

Run Start Time UTC Date/Time

Run Start Date/Time Date/Time

Table Name Table Name

#### 1 - Create Catalog Task



## Standard laptop task

Inactive



View:



Test



Activate



\* Requested Item [Requested Item] Trigger -> Requested Item ...

Short Description Laptop need to Configured

Fields Description Laptop need to Configured

Assignment group Hardware

Approval Approved

+ Add field value

Wait ☒

Template Catalog Item [Catalog Item] Select Template Catalog Item Data Pill Picker for Wait

Catalog Variables Available Selected

### Data Collapse All

#### Flow Variables

#### Trigger - Service Catalog

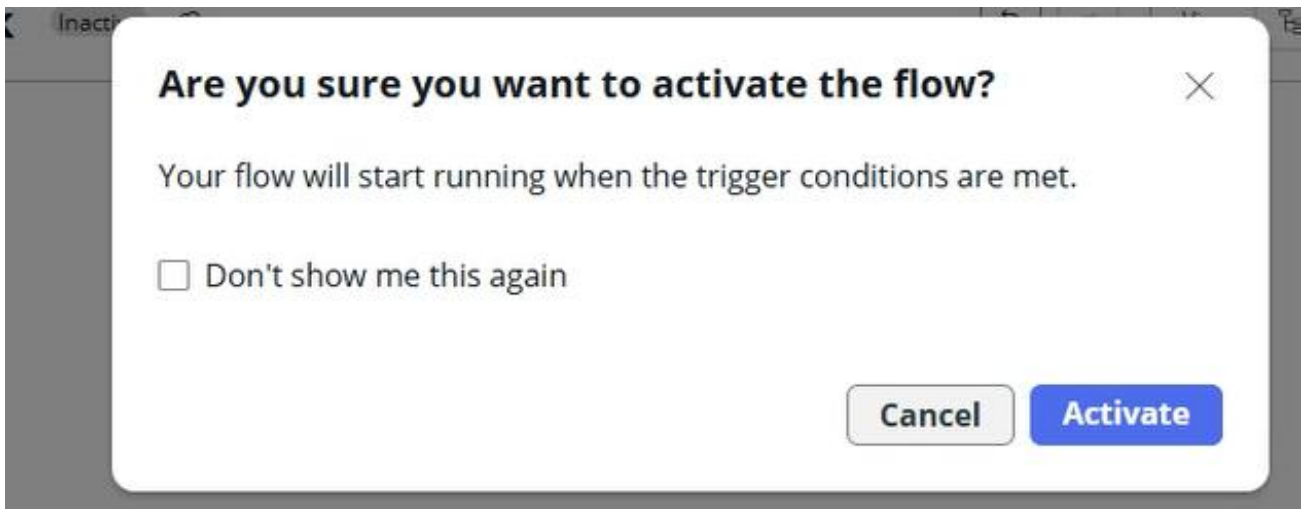
#### Requested Item Record

Run Start Time UTC Date/Time

Run Start Date/Time Date/Time

Table Name Table Name

#### 1 - Create Catalog Task



## **Milestone 2 : Flow assignment**

### **Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.**

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name " Standard Laptop Task".
8. Click on the menu to save the record.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface. On the left, a search bar contains 'maintain items'. Below it, the 'FAVORITES' section shows 'No Results'. The 'ALL RESULTS' section shows a list of items under 'Service Catalog' and 'Catalog Definitions', with 'Maintain Items' highlighted. On the right, a table lists catalog items with columns: Name, Short description, Active, Roles, Catalogs, Category, Price, Type, and Updated.

| Name                                      | Short description     | Active | Roles | Catalogs        | Category    | Price      | Type | Updated             |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------|-------|-----------------|-------------|------------|------|---------------------|
| Standard Laptop                           | Lenovo - Carbon x1    | true   |       | Service Catalog | Hardware    | \$1,100.00 | Item | 2022-11-20 20:46:33 |
| StarTech Mini Display Port to DVI Adapter | PC / Mac Compatible   | false  |       | Service Catalog | Peripherals | \$17.23    | Item | 2022-11-20 20:46:33 |
| StarTech Mini Display Port to VGA Adapter | PC / Mac Compatible   | true   |       | Service Catalog | Peripherals | \$24.50    | Item | 2022-11-20 20:46:33 |
| StarTech USB Mini Hub                     | 4 Port, USB 2.0       | true   |       | Service Catalog | Peripherals | \$11.55    | Item | 2022-11-20 20:46:33 |
| StarTech USB to DVI Adapter               | Multi Monitor Adapter | true   |       | Service Catalog | Peripherals | \$49.99    | Item | 2022-11-20 20:46:33 |
| STM MacBook Air Sleeve                    | STM Mac Sleeve - S13" | true   |       | Service Catalog | Peripherals | \$24.26    | Item | 2022-11-20 20:46:33 |

The screenshot shows the 'Catalog Item' form for 'Standard Laptop'. The form includes fields for Name, Application, Catalogs, Category, State, Checked out, and Owner. The 'Process Engine' tab is selected, showing a message: 'Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog Item. Only one engine can be selected.' The 'Flow' field is set to 'Standard laptop task'.

## Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

### Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
4. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.

servicenow

AllFavoritesHistoryWorkspaces

Standard Laptop

Search

Search catalog

Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop

Order this Item

Price

Quantity

Subtotal

Delivery to

Order Now

Order Now

Add to Cart

Shopping Cart

Empty

Lenovo - Carbon x1

x1 Carbon

The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.

Technical Specs:

- Intel core i5 processor
- 512GB solid state drive (SSD)
- Backlit keyboard

Optional Software

☐ Adobe Acrobat

☐ Adobe Photoshop

Additional software requirements

- Now we will see the Order status
- In that click on the Request Number

Order Status

Back to CatalogContinue ShoppingHome

Thank you, your request has been submitted

Order Placed: 2026-09-26 08:51:04

Request Number: REQ0010001

Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order: 2026-09-26

| Description (Includes Annual Charges) | Delivery Date | Stage | Price (ea.)                            | Quantity | Total                                  |
|---------------------------------------|---------------|-------|----------------------------------------|----------|----------------------------------------|
| Lenovo - Carbon x1                    | 2026-09-26    |       | ₹105,399.0617<br>+₹9,581.7329 Annually | 1        | ₹105,399.0617<br>+₹9,581.7329 Annually |
|                                       |               |       |                                        | Total    | ₹105,399.0617<br>+₹9,581.7329 Annually |

Back to CatalogContinue ShoppingHome

- It will open the Requested number record.
- Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.

servicenow All Favorites History Admin : Request - REQ0010001 Search

Request REQ0010001 Discuss Follow Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Impact 3 - Low  
Opened by System Administrator  
Priority 4 - Low  
State Open

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Requested Items (1) **Approvers (1)** Recurring Prices (1)

State Search Actions on selected rows... Edit

Approval for = REQ0010001

| State     | Approver       | Comments | Created             |
|-----------|----------------|----------|---------------------|
| Requested | Eric Schroeder |          | 2026-09-26 08:51:13 |

1 to 1 of 1

9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

Request REQ0010001 Discuss Follow Update Add New Item Cancel Request

Impact 3 - Low  
Opened by System Administrator  
Priority 4 - Low  
State Open

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Requested Items (1) Recurring Prices (1)

State Search Actions on selected rows... Edit

Approval for = REQ0010001

Show Matching  
 Filter Out  
 Copy URL to Clipboard  
 Copy sys\_id  
 Assign Tag  
**Approve**  
 Reject

| State     | Approver       | Comments | Created             |
|-----------|----------------|----------|---------------------|
| Requested | Eric Schroeder |          | 2026-09-26 08:51:13 |

1 to 1 of 1

10. Then click on the Requested item Section

11. Open that Requested Item record

Requested Item RITM0010001 Discuss Follow Update Delete

State Open

Update Delete

Related Links  
[Flow Context](#)

Catalog Tasks (1) **Approvers** Group approvals

Number Search Actions on selected rows... New

Request item = RITM0010001

| Number        | Assignment group | Assigned to | Short description         | Actual start        | Actual end | Order |
|---------------|------------------|-------------|---------------------------|---------------------|------------|-------|
| SCTASK0010001 | Hardware         | (empty)     | Laptop need to Configured | 2026-09-26 08:53:04 | (empty)    |       |

1 to 1 of 1

12. Scroll down to the “ Catalog tasks ” Section

13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

The screenshot displays a ServiceNow Catalog Task record for SCTASK0010001. The interface includes a header with navigation icons and buttons for 'Follow', 'Update', 'Close Task', and 'Delete'. The form is organized into two columns. The left column contains fields for 'Number' (SCTASK0010001), 'Assigned to' (with a search icon), 'Configuration item' (with a search icon), 'Active' (checked), 'Short description' (Laptop need to Configured), 'Description' (Laptop need to Configured), and 'Work notes' (with a yellow highlight). The right column contains dropdown menus for 'Approval' (Approved), 'Priority' (4 - Low), and 'State' (Open). Below these are fields for 'Request item' (RITM0010001) and 'Requested for' (System Administrator), each with a search icon and an information icon. At the bottom right, there are icons for a lightbulb and a document.

## Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.